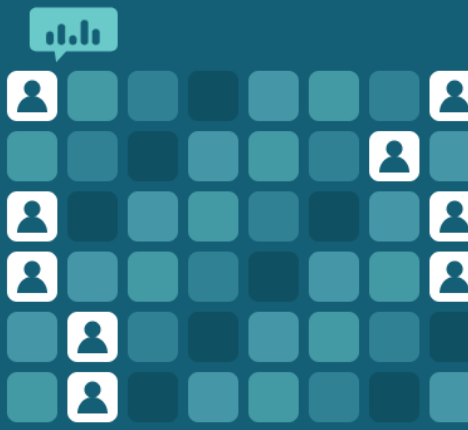
Place-based data training

Activities workbook

Module 1.1: Data privacy



This training brings together practical guidance for using data in place-based work. It draws on PLACE and Seer Data's work alongside place-based initiatives across Australia.

The training covers the journey many place-based initiatives go on – from finding and accessing data to sharing it, making sense of it with community and using it to support local decisions and action.

Who is it for?

It is designed for people working in or supporting place-based initiatives. You might be new to working with data or already using and managing data as part of your everyday rhythm.

How to use this workbook

Throughout the training, you'll find opportunities to reflect on your work and consider how the ideas and tools apply in your place or initiative. This workbook brings together the activities for this module.

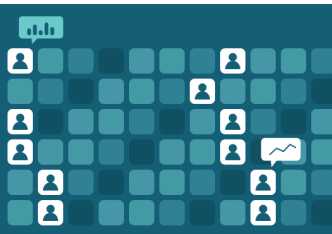
You can work through the training from beginning to end, or choose the modules most relevant to your role, experience and current work. We recommend starting with Welcome to place-based data training. You can return to other sections as you need them.

You can also connect with others doing the training to ask questions, share what you're learning and learn from their experience on PLACExCHANGE at **pxc.placeaustralia.org**.

A collaboration between

PLACE
Partnerships for Local Action & Community Empowerment

Seer
Data & Analytics



Module

1.1 Data privacy

Section 1	Understanding the Privacy Act	2 activities
Section 2	Protecting personal information	2 activities
Section 3	Consent and ethical handling	2 activities

Try this now: identify the personal information your initiative works with

Try this now Apply to your place 1

Pick one kind of personal information your initiative works with. Write down the kind of information, not any person's actual details. The first row is an example.

This table is a way to identify the personal information your initiative works with: what it is, who holds it, why it is collected, and whether the Privacy Act applies.

You will add to it in the next exercise.

Information we work with (kind, not details)	Where does it come from/who holds it?	Why is it collected/used?	Does the Privacy Act apply?
Contact details from the school holiday program sign-up form	The neighbourhood centre, which runs the program for the partnership	To confirm places and contact a parent or carer on the day	Not sure. Turnover is under $3 million, so we need to check whether one of the exceptions for smaller organisations applies

Try this now: classify personal and sensitive information

Try this now Apply to your place 2

Go back to the row you started in the exercise above. For that information, name whether it is personal, sensitive or neither, and what extra care it needs.

The information (from the exercise above)	Personal, sensitive or neither?	What makes you classify it this way, and what extra care can you take?
Contact details and allergy notes from the holiday program sign-up form	Personal. The allergy and medication notes are health information, so that part is sensitive	Store it securely, limit who can see it, and only keep it while the program runs

Try this now: identify who covers privacy

Try this now Apply to your place 1

Go back to the information you recorded in Section 1. For each item, identify:

- Which organisation collects, stores or uses the information
- Who you would contact if you had a privacy question or concern
- Which document or process explains how the information is handled
- What you still need to find out

If you do not know an answer, write "Not yet clear".

The information (from Section 1)	Who is responsible for privacy	Which document says so	What I still need to find out
Contact details and allergy notes from the holiday program sign-up form	Nobody yet. The program coordinator collects the forms; the centre manager assumes the partnership handles it	None. The centre has a privacy policy, but the holiday program is not mentioned in it	Who will be the Privacy Lead, and whether the program needs its own privacy notice

Try this now: your initial response plan

Try this now Apply to your place 2

For the information you have been tracking, write down what you would need to know if it ended up somewhere it should not.

If this information leaked, how would we notice?	Who I tell first	Where our response plan is, or who would know	What I do not decide on my own
A parent rings to ask why they got a strange message. There is no alert on the shared drive	The centre manager, the same day, even if I am not sure it is serious	Not sure there is one. The centre manager or backbone coordinator would know	Whether it is serious enough to notify families and the Office of the Australian Information Commissioner. That needs the people named in the plan

Try this now: test one consent process

Try this now | Apply to your place 1

Take one consent process your initiative uses: a form, a verbal question at intake, or a line on a sign-up sheet. Test it against the four elements of valid consent. Answer each column with yes, no or not sure, and add a few words of evidence. Then write the one change that would improve it most.

The consent process I am testing	Informed?	Voluntary?	Current and specific?	Capacity?	The one change I would make
Holiday program sign-up form, one tick box	No. It does not say who will see the information	No. One box covers attendance, photos and the newsletter	No. It says “and future programs”, which is undefined	Not sure. A parent signs, but 15- and 16-year-olds sign for themselves	Split the one box into three, and say who sees the information

Try this now: decide – using or sharing?

Try this now | Apply to your place 2

For one piece of information your initiative holds, work through whether you are using it or sharing it, and whether that is allowed.

The information	Am I using it or sharing it?	For the reason it was collected, or a new one?	Allowed, or do I need consent?
A family’s contact details, given to a partner service for a referral	Sharing. The partner is a separate organisation	A new reason. It was collected to run the program, not to refer	I need the family’s consent before sharing